

The Rainy-Day Drumbeat

Easy start · Indoors · Kid can lead · Ages 4–9 · 15 min

Brought to you by Stacey — “If it makes a sound, it can make a song.”

A canceled afternoon turns into a kitchen drum kit and a beat the whole house can clap along to.

WHAT YOU NEED

- Plastic cups, tubs, and boxes
- Wooden spoons
- A tea towel to soften anything too loud

BEFORE YOU START

Nothing made of glass.

Agree on a stop signal before you start, so the drumming can end without an argument.

How to make it

- 1 Collect five things that make five different sounds. Tap each one and listen.
- 2 Put them in order from lowest sound to highest sound.
- 3 Clap a pattern of four: loud, quiet, quiet, loud. Say it out loud until your hands can do it without you thinking.
- 4 Play that same pattern on your lowest drum.
- 5 Add a second pattern on a higher drum that fits in the gaps.
- 6 Teach the pattern to someone else and play it together twice through.

TALK ABOUT IT

What is a rhythm you hear every day without thinking about it?

TRY THIS TOO

Make it a call and response. One person plays two beats, the other answers with two different ones.

DID YOU KNOW? · SOUND & RHYTHM

Rhythm is a pattern of sound that repeats. A beat only becomes a rhythm when it comes back around.

Once your ears learn the pattern, they start predicting it, which is why a good rhythm makes people want to move before they decide to.